



level Up

A COLLECTION OF PRO TIPS FOR EVERYTHING. Without being limited to a particular topic, these tips are from popular software, to coding, to browsers, search, storage rules, password rules, mobile device hacks, bios cracking, tweaks explained and everything tech under the sun.



Tips to improve your cloud storage game

Manage cloud storage like an ace

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CLOUD COMPUTING, TODAY, IS EXTREMELY UBIQUITOUS.

You'd be hard-pressed to find a service that doesn't use the cloud in some form or the other. The cloud occupies the centre stage of most modern computing needs.

Though it serves a myriad of purposes, storage and retrieval on demand is one of the cloud's primary use cases. Whether you are on iOS, Android, Windows, Mac, or Linux, chances are that you are already using a cloud service. Most cloud storage sync happens in the background with minimal user interven-

tion. However, with limited storage reserves, things can quickly get out of hand forcing you to cough up more for added storage. In this article, we will explore a few tips that make you an ace in managing files in your cloud.



FIND OUT WHAT'S GOBBLING UP ALL THE SPACE

With most default setups, modern operating systems often backup a lot of stuff to the cloud on their own. Over time, these can eat away substantial amounts of storage. So, here's what you can do:

Check your current storage status. Most storage managers will show an infographic of what's taking up space and allow you to manage individual categories such as photos, mail, and documents.

They often also offer options to perform an automatic cleanup based on certain criteria, such as photos older than a year, or emails with large attachments, etc.



CLEAR OLD MESSAGES

Though individual messages hardly cause any blip in your storage metre's radar, these can quickly add up overtime. Especially if your messages contain attachments, emojis, or high-res photos. Fortunately, there are few ways to keep your messaging activity more organised and leaner.

Browse through your messages collection and see what all can be trashed. Take a screenshot of the important ones and delete the ones you don't need. On iOS, messages can be easily triaged

by a simple swipe to the left. You can also delete individual attachments you don't need.

If you need more functionality than the default Android Messaging app, SMS Organizer from Microsoft is an alternative that offers more features and control over SMS backups to OneDrive.

Other culprits include IM apps such as WhatsApp, Telegram, and Signal. Telegram is entirely cloud-based, so you need not have any file stored on device unless needed.

Signal uses on-device encryption, which means all files are only locally available.

WhatsApp does both local and cloud backup. WhatsApp is often the de facto IM for most and users exchange a barrage of multimedia every hour. WhatsApp backups that contain media quickly take up valuable on-device and cloud storage space.

In WhatsApp, you can choose not to save multimedia to your phone's gallery if you want to save some space on your device. If you're backing up to the cloud, it is probably a good idea to save large video files elsewhere and back up just messages and photos. To do that, head over to WhatsApp settings > Chats > Chat backup and toggle the "Include videos" option to off.



BE PHOTO-WISE

Millions of photos are uploaded by the hour on social media, which means that your phone quickly gets burdened with both photos you take and those you